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City drops slavery report over issues on researcher

Former Tufts professor accused of shoddy work

By Kris Hooks
GLOBE STAFF
and Meghan E. Irons
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The City of Boston has decided to scrap a far-reaching report on the legacy of slavery here months after one of its researchers was accused of misrepresenting details that were central to a book on slavery that she wrote.

Mayor Michelle Wu's administration said Tuesday that Tufts University returned the \$335,000 the city paid for a report on the role of Boston and Massachusetts in the trans-Atlantic slave trade and its legacy from 1620 to 1940. Kerri K. Greenidge, a former Tufts University professor whose book on slavery, published in 2022, has come under scrutiny, was tapped along with two other Tufts researchers to compile the report.

"The faculty member who had been leading the project is no longer employed by the university," read a joint statement from the mayor's office and Tufts, referring to Greenidge. "The university has been unable to identify a replacement researcher with the subject-matter expertise neces-

REPARATIONS, Page A6

Holdout juror faced many questions — but which ones?

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

Prospective jurors in the Lindsay Clancy murder trial were required to answer a wide range of questions: Would you be biased against the female defendant for any reason? Did you believe the defense known as the insanity plea was valid? Could you follow the evidence and not your personal beliefs?

Regular court procedure dictated they also write a summary disclosing interactions with law

►Healey proposes injecting \$2 million into a state program to help new mothers. B1.

enforcement and the judicial system, including whether any had a criminal record, and to sign it under penalty of perjury. And prosecutors and defense attorneys also had the wherewithal to search court databases for additional information on the prospective jurors.

And in one case, either truthful answers to the questionnaire or a database query would have

JURORS, Page A10

AI makes some strange bedfellows

Politicians stake out stands, and it's not always on party lines

By Tal Kopan
and Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As companies develop artificial intelligence at breakneck speed, pouring in vast amounts of money to achieve tech supremacy, there's a parallel race underway — the race to stake out political positions and appeal to voters concerned about AI's impact.

A stream of increasingly alarm-

ing headlines has vaulted the promise and pitfalls of AI into the center of the national conversation. Now politicians — who have varying levels of tech understanding — are scrambling to articulate policies on everything from the pace of AI progress to the proliferation of data centers drawing opposition around the country.

The fast-moving technology represents a rare thing in American politics: a policy arena where

the entrenched political parties don't yet have calcified positions and voters are engaged and perhaps persuadable on the issues, which are nuanced. As politicians take the pulse of their constituents and begin to take their stands, the typical party lines are not as clear-cut as usual.

There's also a lack of consensus on AI, meaning the possibility for federal action this year is slim to none.

Congress has a variety of proposals under discussion — including a bill that would create safety requirements for AI development coauthored by Westford Representative Lori Trahan — but none have real momentum, and Congress has vanishingly few days of legislative work scheduled before November. The Trump administration has made clear it does not intend to take unilateral action on the issue.

Instead, politicians are channeling what they feel is voter frustra-

AI, Page A6



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Without drainage, basement flooding has long been a fact of life on Ping On Alley. The city says it's a private way.

In the alley, resentment runs deep

Chinatown residents say the city needs to step up on a puddle that won't die

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

This is a story about a big puddle, yes, but it's about much more than that: historic marginalization, public health, and city services in a neighborhood that has served as a beachhead for immigrants for more than a century.

But first, the puddle: it's a collection of rainwater in one of Chinatown's alleys, near a public parking lot and behind a multilevel brick building whose front faces Edinboro

Street. It's a short walk away from the Chinatown Gate. The body of water remains, with a length of more than 30 paces, three days after the last rain.

It's been here for years, flooding basements and spawning clouds of mosquitoes in the most urban of landscapes. Locals say it takes weeks of no rain and hot temperatures for the puddle to fully evaporate, only to return after the next storm.

Wen Feng Huang has owned 180 Cafe on Edinboro Street for almost a decade.

The backdoor to her business faces the alley. After a rain, whenever a car passes through the puddle, it pushes the water into her basement, flooding it.

What happens after that? She mimes pushing water around with a squeegee. "All the time," she said through an interpreter.

This year has been particularly bad for the basement flooding. She doesn't know why, only that it has been a headache.

Like many alleys, the sun doesn't shine

CHINATOWN, Page A10

Summer, bummer

Wednesday: Still beautiful.
High 75-80. Low 64-69.

Thursday: Not so beautiful.
High 75-80. Low 65-70.

Sunrise: 6:25 Sunset: 6:52

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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Treat yourself

Indulging in little luxuries is a popular way to get around the financial squeeze. **G1.**

The chief justice of the New Hampshire Supreme Court resigned, admitting he violated a code of conduct in a matter involving a \$50,000 payout to a staffer. **B1.**

Democrats have developed a clear advantage over Republicans as the president has lost the public's trust on the economy, a new poll found. **A5.**

Novels (check phone) now too much (check) for distracted teens (check)

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

High school English teachers are assigning fewer novels because, in the internet slang of distracted teenagers, full-length books are too much of a slog for students with a TL;DR mindset.

In other words: "too long; didn't read."

The impulse to reach for a phone instead of a book has left teens with dwindling attention spans, making them unwilling — or unable — to dig

into full novels for school or pleasure.

"One of the biggest things students are lacking now is reading stamina," said Robert Comeau, who teaches English at the O'Bryant School of Mathematics and Science in Boston. "It's like running. It's like exercise. If you're not reading a chunk every day, you're not building up those muscles."

Students' reluctance to read has prompted teachers across the country to stop assigning as many full-length

READING, Page A7



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